

Kamal Joshi

Technical Leader, Platform Identity | Go | OAuth 2.0 | OIDC | OPA | AWS | Kubernetes | Cisco Identity

Austin, TX | Open to remote-friendly and hybrid roles | Open to relocation for the right opportunity
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical leader with deep hands-on experience designing and delivering scalable Identity infrastructure within the Cisco ecosystem — the exact intersection this role requires. Built and owned the Authorization Service, API Gateway, and identity enforcement layer for Cisco Secure Access, implementing OAuth 2.0/OIDC token flows, API key lifecycle management, and OPA-based policy enforcement across a multi-tenant SaaS platform. Drove cross-service Splunk and CloudEvents identity and event format design across platform teams, with direct familiarity with the Cisco Identity architecture from the inside. Fluent in AI-assisted engineering: daily use of GitHub Copilot and Claude Code to accelerate development while owning architecture, security, and quality.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Identity and access management:** OAuth 2.0/OIDC, JWT/JWKS, OPA policy enforcement, API key lifecycle, TLS certificate management, multi-tenant authorization, identity standards (IETF OAuth WG, OpenID)
- **Technical leadership:** leading distributed engineering teams, scoping and decomposing complex projects, architecture reviews, 1-on-1 coaching, detailed code review feedback, mitigating technical debt
- **Security:** vulnerability assessment, OWASP secure coding (100+ warnings to zero), ISMAP security certification, sovereign/GovCloud environments, security-sensitive automation
- **Backend engineering:** Go (Golang), Java, REST, gRPC, JSON/HTTP APIs, microservices, event-driven systems
- **Cloud and infrastructure:** AWS (ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD
- **AI-assisted development:** daily use of GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, and Codex; pioneered team-wide Copilot adoption; working familiarity with agentic tool patterns (LLM + memory + tool use)

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - Present | Austin, TX

- Owned the **Authorization Service** and **API Gateway** — the core Identity enforcement layer for Cisco Secure Access — designing **OAuth 2.0/OIDC** token flows, **API key management**, and **OPA policy enforcement** across a multi-tenant, customer-facing SaaS platform.
- Drove cross-service design for **Splunk** and CloudEvents event formats across alerts, security events, integrations, and notifications services — working directly within the Cisco Identity and observability architecture this team sits at the center of.
- Mapped **AuthSvc TLS secret synchronization** and **API key refresh behavior** across deployment tooling, Secrets Manager, Kubernetes, and Kong — eliminating ambiguity in security-sensitive automation paths and contributing to the Cisco unified identity story.
- **Prevented security-event message loss** during a production incident by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 orgs**, and redriving messages within **5-10 minutes** — full incident ownership from detection to resolution.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** through API key auth and rate-limit behavior, driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- **Diagnosed and fixed a critical integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation**, contributing directly to the **customer's purchase decision**.
- Served as the primary technical anchor for cross-timezone coordination, bridging geographically distributed teams during coverage gaps.

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Built **auth-tools**, an internal **authorization library** adopted across multiple platform services to simplify OAuth/policy enforcement integration — a foundational identity component for the APIX platform.
- Led **ISMAP security certification** for the APIX platform, coordinating cross-functional compliance requirements and meeting all deadlines.
- Integrated **AI tooling (GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Codex)** into daily engineering workflow; pioneered team-wide Copilot adoption ahead of broader Cisco AI initiatives.
- Mentored early-in-career engineers through detailed code review feedback and 1-on-1 architecture guidance.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Built **OIDC/OAuth 2.0** authentication and authorization flows; deployed **OPA as a sidecar** for authorization policy enforcement (2020-2021).
- Designed and implemented **Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs** for cloud-native data ingestion platforms.
- Filed [MicahParks/compatibility-keyfunc#2](#): identified a **base64 URL decoding bug in RSA key modulus parsing** in a widely-used Go JWT/JWKS library.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Oracle, Cognizant, Collabera, and others | January 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and enterprise domains.
- Built foundation in Java, REST APIs, service integrations, and maintainable engineering practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University